

Figure 1: An application showing the use of skeuomorphism

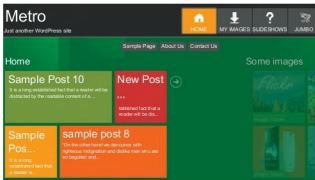


Figure 2: WordPress theme showing the use of Metro Design



Figure 3: An illustration of different components in Flat Design

design that serve no user interface function, such as handles, screws and ventilation holes. Even systems that do not employ literal images of some physical object frequently contain skeuomorphic elements, such as slider bars that emulate linear potentiometers and tabs that behave like tabbed file folders.

Skeuomorphs need not be visual. The shutter-click sound emitted by most camera phones when taking a picture is an auditory skeuomorph; it does not come from a mechanical shutter, which camera phones lack, but from a sound file in the phone's operating system. Another example is the swiping hand gesture for turning the 'pages' or screens of a tablet. People who are in favour of this language argue that it makes



Figure 4: One of the goals of Material Design, which is consistent design across different screen sizes

it easier for those familiar with the original device to use the digital emulation by making certain affordances stronger. On the other hand, people opposing this design language say that it requires resemblance of the original object, so it limits the creativity of a programmer or of UI designers to design or try anything new in their interfaces.

Metro Design

Metro is a typography- and geometry-focused design language created by Microsoft primarily for user interfaces. A key design principle is better focus on the content of applications, relying more on typography and less on graphics (content before chrome). Early examples of Metro principles can be found in Encarta 95 and MSN 2.0. The design language evolved in Windows Media Centre and Zune, and was formally introduced as 'Metro' during the unveiling of Windows Phone 7. It has since been incorporated into several of the company's other products, including the Xbox 360 system software, Xbox One, Windows 8, Windows Phone, and *Outlook.com* under the names Microsoft Design language and Modern UI after Microsoft discontinued the name 'Metro' supposedly because of trademark issues.

Flat Design

Flat Design is a minimalist UI design genre, or design language, currently used in various graphical user interfaces (such as websites or Web applications). Flat Design is a style of interface design without any stylistic elements that gives the illusion of three dimensions (such as excessive use of drop shadows, gradients or textures) and is focused on a minimalist use of simple elements, typography and flat colours. Designers may prefer Flat Design because it allows interface designs to be more streamlined and efficient. It makes it easier to quickly convey information while still looking visually appealing and approachable. It also makes it easier to design an interface that is responsive to changes in browser size across different devices. With minimal design elements, websites are able to load faster and resize easily, and still look sharp on high-definition screens. As a design approach, it is often contrasted to skeuomorphism and rich design. (Though it should be noted that Flat Design can and does use skeuomorphs just as much